

Resource: Study Notes - Profiles (Tyndale)

Aquifer Open Study Notes (Profiles)

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Women Named Mary

The Gospels mention four other Marys besides the mother of Jesus:

1. *Mary Magdalene*, likely from Magdala in Galilee, was freed from demon possession by Jesus ([Mark 16:9](#)). She became a loyal follower and supported Jesus and his disciples financially ([Luke 8:1-3](#); see also [Matthew 27:55-56](#); [Mark 15:40-41](#)). She witnessed Jesus's death on the cross and his burial ([Matthew 27:55-61](#); [Mark 15:40-47](#); [John 19:25](#); compare [Luke 23:49, 55-56](#)). She went to the tomb early on Sunday morning with burial spices. She was among the first to hear that Jesus had risen from the dead ([Matthew 28:1-8](#); [Mark 16:1-8](#); [Luke 24:1-11, 22-24](#)). She was also the first to see the risen Jesus ([Matthew 28:9-10](#); [Mark 16:9-11](#); [John 20:1-2, 11-18](#)).
2. *Mary, the mother of James the younger* (not the apostle) and Joseph, was among the women present at Jesus's death on the cross and his burial ([Matthew 27:55-61](#); [Mark 15:40-47](#); see also [Luke 23:49, 55](#)). Like Mary Magdalene, she was among the first to hear that Jesus had risen from the dead ([Matthew 28:1-8](#); [Mark 16:1-8](#); [Luke 24:1-11](#)). She was also one of the first to see the risen Jesus ([Matthew 28:9-10](#)).
3. *Mary of Bethany* was Martha and Lazarus's sister. Jesus loved their family very much ([John 11:5](#)). Jesus praised Mary for wanting to learn from him ([Luke 10:38-42](#)). Soon after Jesus raised her brother from the dead ([John 11:32-45](#)), Mary anointed Jesus's feet with very expensive perfume. Jesus defended her when others said it was wasteful ([John 12:1-11](#); compare [Matthew 26:6-13](#); [Mark 14:3-9](#)).
4. *Mary, the wife of Clopas*, was among the women watching when Jesus died on the cross ([John 19:25](#)). The New Testament does not mention her husband, Clopas, elsewhere.

Passages for Further Study

[Matthew 27:55-61](#); [28:1](#); [Mark 15:40-47](#); [16:1-11](#); [Luke 8:2-3](#); [10:38-42](#); [24:1-10](#); [John 11:1-6](#), [17-24](#); [12:3-8](#); [19:25](#); [20:1-2](#), [11-18](#); [Acts 12:12](#)